

Ryan Ott

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WORK EXPERIENCE

Explainable AI for Vehicle Fault Classification — BMW Group Munich, Jan 2025 - Current

Evaluating and implementing a range of explainable AI methods to optimise BMW's deep learning pipeline for vehicle fault classification. Improvements in both accuracy and efficiency have been achieved, with insights into key feature importances and explanations for model decisions aiding further development and cooperation with engineers.

Board Member for Inclusive AI — ELLIS Amsterdam, Nov 2024 - Current

Under the European Laboratory for Learning and Intelligent Systems (ELLIS), I contribute to initiatives aimed at promoting diversity and inclusion in AI research and development. We supply funding and support for attending conferences, host panels and workshops, and provide mentorship to underrepresented groups in the field of AI.

AI for Space Standards Analysis — ESA Noordwijk, Aug 2024 - Oct 2024

Built NLP-based machine learning tools for the European Space Agency (ESA) to analyze and consolidate space mission technical standards. The tools from this project are now actively used by the ECSS (European Cooperation for Space Standardization) in its NextGen project to define the next generation of space standards.

Fintech Product Management & Technical Support — Adyen Amsterdam, Nov 2021 – Jul 2024

Coordinated the deprecation of a critical legacy feature of the online payments platform, aligning product, development and legal teams to ensure a seamless transition for merchants. Improved technical documentation by applying topic extraction and sentiment analysis to internal communications. Supported merchants and internal teams with API configuration, Python automation, and resolution of complex payment integration issues.

PROJECTS

Investigating Visually Grounded Language Embeddings

Research project, probing the language embedding space of a pre-trained vision-and-language model to understand how incorporating visual information affects the language embeddings. Won 1st place at the UvA *Interpretability and Explainability in AI* conference in 2024.

Transformer for Summarisation

Bachelor thesis, implementing and training an encoder-decoder transformer model from scratch to generate abstracts of news articles under tight resource constraints.

EDUCATION

2023 - present **MSc Artificial Intelligence** at Universiteit van Amsterdam GPA: 8.3

2020 - 2023 **BSc Artificial Intelligence** at Vrije Universiteit Amsterdam GPA: 8.4

PUBLICATIONS

Sauter, Adrian et al. (2024). ““Studying How to Efficiently and Effectively Guide Models with Explanations” - A Reproducibility Study”. In: *Transactions on Machine Learning Research*. Presented at the 38th annual Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS) 2024 in Vancouver, Canada. ISSN: 2835-8856. URL: <https://openreview.net/forum?id=9ZzASCVhDF>.

SKILLS

Languages English (native), German (native), Dutch (native), Russian (elementary)

Technology Python, PyTorch, Sklearn, Scipy, Numpy, Pandas, C#, Java, SQL, Git, Linux